



VANCOUVER AQUARIUM DEVELOPMENT PERMIT

Park Board Committee Meeting
Monday, March 30, 2026



PURPOSE/OBJECTIVES

- Present proposed Vancouver Aquarium upgrade to the Park Board
- Review the Vancouver Aquarium's request to introduce the upgrade into the existing footprint within Stanley Park
- Seek the Board's approval for the Development Permit



BACKGROUND

- The Vancouver Aquarium is a long-standing partner and anchor attraction within Stanley Park
- Planned upgrade to the BC Wild Coast exhibit to renew end-of-life systems
- Position the exhibit as a flagship experience for decades to come



PROJECT OVERVIEW

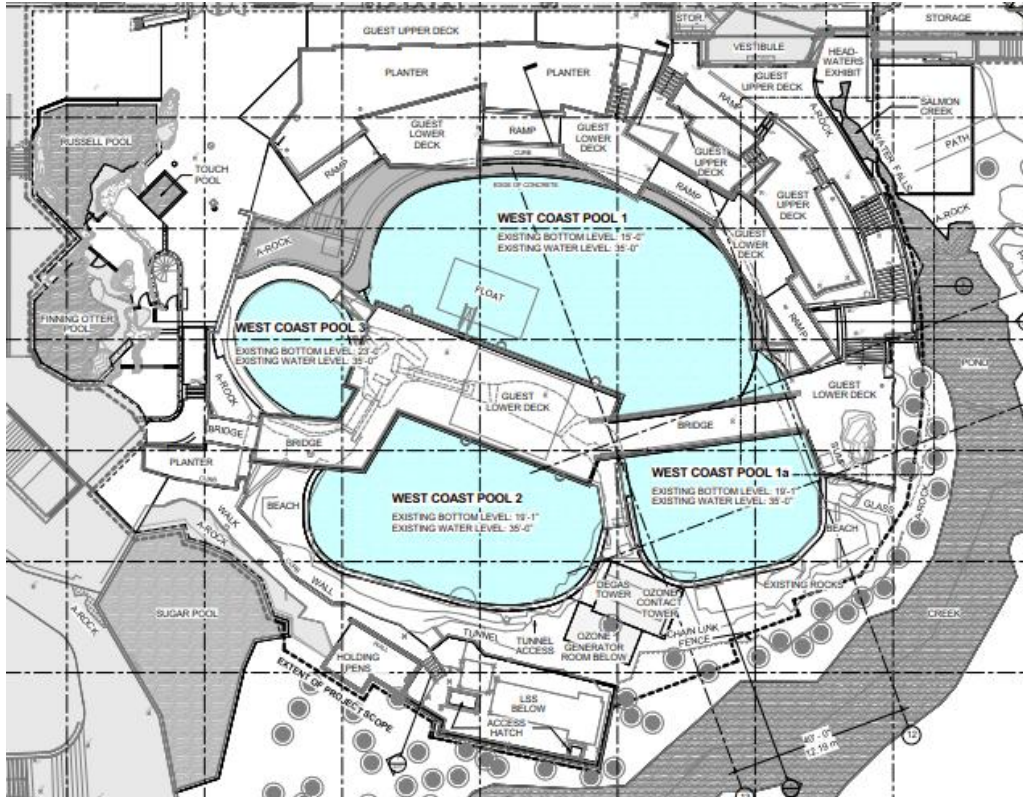
- Substantial investment within the existing Vancouver Aquarium footprint within Stanley Park
 - Extends habitat life and improves animal care
 - Transforms the guest experience
 - Modernizes infrastructure
 - Expands revenue and event potential
- Proposed opening in late 2027



PROJECT OVERVIEW – LOCATION

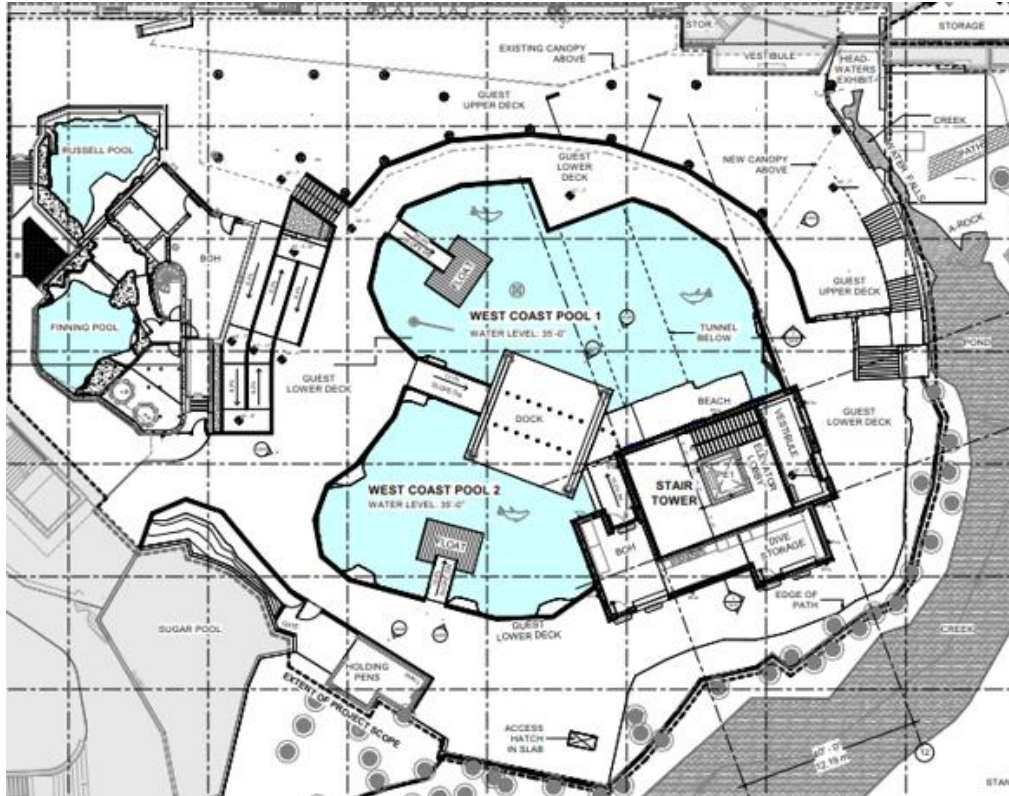


PROJECT OVERVIEW – CURRENT EXHIBIT



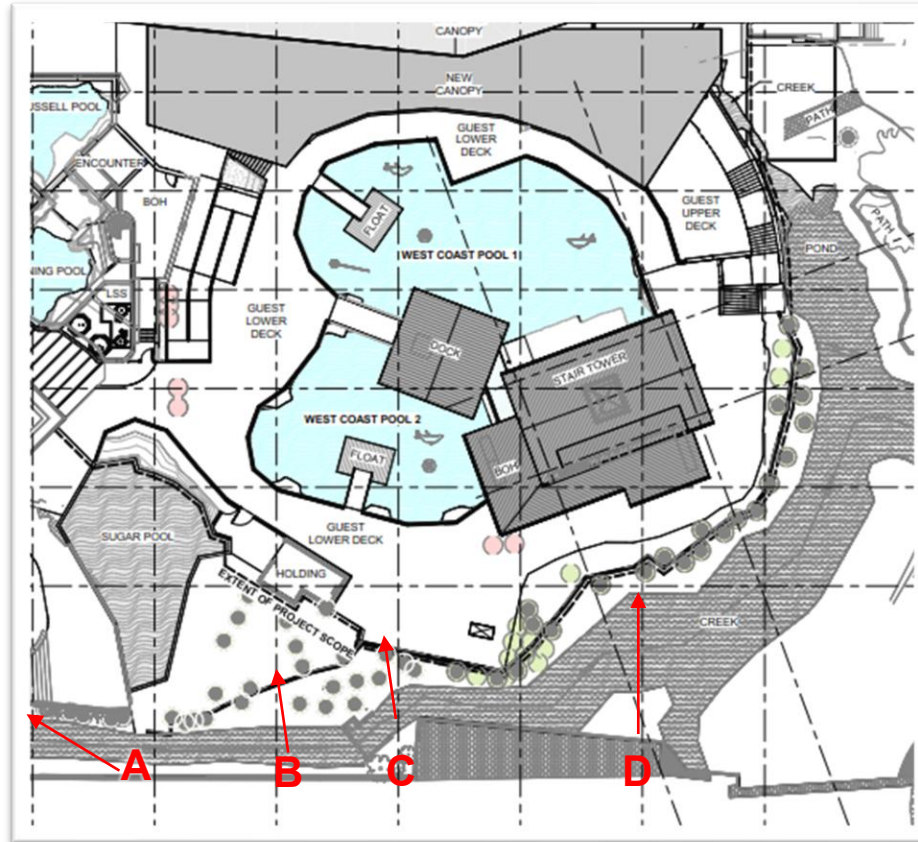
- Wild Coast – currently 4 pools which will be reduced to 2 pools
- Visitors circulate through the middle of exhibit; no ability to circulate 360 degrees
- Accessibility challenges for wheelchairs and strollers to navigate this outdoor area

PROJECT OVERVIEW – PROPOSED EXHIBIT



- New underwater viewing windows
- New underwater acrylic tunnel
- New enhanced life support mechanical systems
- Enhanced customer experience allows visitors to circulate 360 degrees around pools and lowers viewing deck
- New ramp for improved accessibility
- New public encounter area for Otter Exhibit

PROJECT OVERVIEW – VIEWS FROM THE PARK



PROJECT OVERVIEW – VIEWS FROM THE PARK

A



**EXISTING
VIEW**

B



**EXISTING
VIEW**

C



**EXISTING
VIEW**

D



**EXISTING
VIEW**



UNCHANGED



UNCHANGED



**REPLACE WOOD
FENCE**



UNCHANGED

BENEFITS & POTENTIAL RISKS

■ Benefits

- Continued engagement of residents & visitors at the Aquarium
- Renewal of end-of-life assets
- Improved guest experience
- Incremental revenue generation

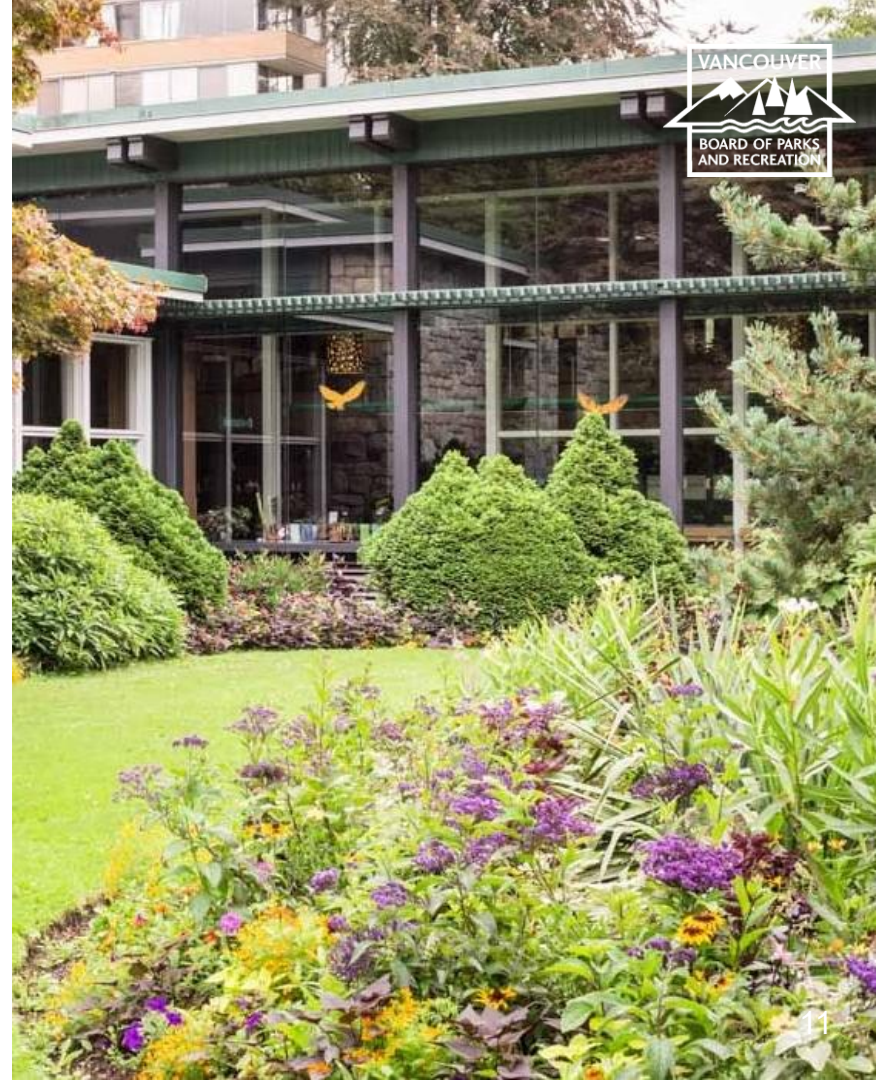
■ Risks

- Archaeological (medium)
- Reputational (low)
- Operational (low)
- Financial (low)



NEXT STEPS

- Submit Building Permit – March 2026
- Start Construction Mobilization – Summer 2026
- Open Exhibit – Late 2027



THAT the Vancouver Park Board approve the Vancouver Aquarium Development Permit, proposed within the existing License Area, as outlined in this report.

